Suburb shortlist foundation report

Three four-suburb viewing options: nature-first anchors beside Community comparators

Start viewing with one of three four-suburb options (A, B or C below). Each option puts at least one nature-first anchor (Frankston, Mordialloc or Seaford) beside at least two Community comparators, one of which is a checked "Potential both" suburb (Endeavour Hills or Wheelers Hill). This lets the family see the nature-versus-community trade-off in person. Fifty-one suburbs pass the family's hard filters (price up to $1.5M, Glen Waverley drive up to 90 min, ED drive up to 90 min) and are ranked by the workbook. The top three are the nature-first anchors: **Frankston 7.00 (#1), Mordialloc 6.90 (#2) and Seaford 6.89 (#3)**, then Mentone and Altona. Seven of the top eight are bay or coast suburbs. Beach carries the largest final weight (16.4%), then Nature (14.4%), Train/bus (12.0%) and Village character (11.9%); Near family carries 5.8%. The anchors' own Nature scores are moderate (Frankston 6, Seaford 6, Mordialloc 5; ESTIMATE). The suburbs with Nature 10 (Sassafras, Olinda, Mount Dandenong, Warburton) rank 35th to 50th and are in no option. The six Community comparators are display-only and **not ranked**. No suburb is described here as a confirmed choice: no specific house has been checked anywhere. **The workbook is canonical; nothing here replaces it.** Every figure is labelled CHECKED, ESTIMATE or NEEDS VERIFICATION.

Read-date 27 Oct 2026; comparator update 28 Oct 2026; workbook alignment 28 Oct 2026; Glen Waverley median update 29 Oct 2026. Workbook = "Our Next Home — Family Relocation Scoring Model.xlsx" at commit 5704d65. Print in A4 landscape. Numbers refreshed 5 Nov 2026 (ranks, scores, 0–10 criterion scores only) from workbook sha 841c84acf860 (main 1fd9676), after the 2 Nov 2026 scoring change; narrative not edited.

Update, 28 Oct 2026: what changed since the 27 Oct version
1. **Rankings, scores and tables now reflect the current workbook** (commit 5704d65; ranks and scores identical to 387763a and 7de29d5): every rank, weighted score and 0–10 score below is the workbook's own. The 27 Oct provisional calculation, its weights, its sensitivity tables and its Round 2 scenario ranks have been removed.
2. **Six Community comparators added** (workbook SuburbScorecard rows 67–72, display-only, not ranked): Springvale, Clayton South, Keysborough, Clyde North ("Diverse / lower-green"); Endeavour Hills, Wheelers Hill ("Potential both"; Wheelers Hill community-lighter). All meet the price cap, the 90-min Glen Waverley limit and the public 24-hour ED rule on checked evidence.
3. **Point Cook is Conditional and is not a comparator** (fails the 90-min Glen Waverley cap at 08:00 peak). **Tarneit is Excluded** (family decision 28 Oct 2026) and **Mount Waverley is Excluded** (median over the cap). **Rowville is Reference only.** None of the four is in the scorecard or any option.
4. **Viewing options replaced** by three four-suburb options. Each meets the viewing-shortlist rule (checked in the table below).
5. **Wheelers Hill budget is CHECKED** from the Jellis Craig sold-results report (houses sold under the cap); **suitable-property verification remains outstanding**.
6. **Synthetic test rows** (workbook rows 49–50) are excluded from every table and count.
7. **Comparator drives now use the workbook's 10:00 basis** (Glen Waverley J and ED K = top of the typical range departing 10:00 on a weekday, 28 Oct). The 08:00 ranges are kept only as context, labelled "Peak (08:00), not used in the workbook J/K figures." **Tarneit is excluded by family decision**, not by a drive-time test.

Label	Meaning
CHECKED	Read in a named source (link given here, in the workbook or in the research file).
ESTIMATE	A researcher's judgement or recall, or an automated valuation. Not verified. All Nature, Village, Beach, Shops, Train/bus, City trip and Indian-community scores (workbook columns N, P–S, U, V) are estimates.
NEEDS VERIFICATION	A specific claim that has been looked for and not yet confirmed.

The workbook's Near-family, Hospital and Price scores (columns M, O, T) are formulas from the drive minutes and price, so they carry the label of those inputs.

Drive-time basis (do not compare across rows with different labels)	Applies to
Leave now, 26 Oct	Active Shortlist ranked locations (Google Maps "leave now", not peak)

Drive-time basis (do not compare across rows with different labels)	Applies to
Leave now, 27 Oct	Ranked Watchlist and Open-mind viewing locations, including the anchors **Seaford and Mordialloc**, plus Frankston South (the workbook records these as 27 Oct readings)
10:00 weekday, 28 Oct	The six Community comparators (workbook J and K): top of the Google Maps typical range, departing Wed 28 Oct 2026 10:00

The 10:00 weekday basis is off-peak, like "leave now", but it is not the same reading, so a comparator's minutes should not be set against an anchor's minutes as if they were measured the same way. Comparators' 08:00 ranges appear only as context, labelled "Peak (08:00), not used in the workbook J/K figures."

Viewing options: three groups of four

Viewing-shortlist rule. "The viewing shortlist includes at least two Community comparators, at least one nature-first anchor, and at least one checked Potential-both suburb. Community comparators are not included for diversity figures alone; they must meet the purchase-price cap, verified Glen Waverley travel limit, and public 24-hour ED requirement."

Nature-first anchor = Frankston, Mordialloc or Seaford. Community-first comparator = Springvale, Clayton South or Keysborough (Clyde North is the fourth, in no option). Potential both = Endeavour Hills or Wheelers Hill. Endeavour Hills and Wheelers Hill are themselves Community comparators, so they count towards the two-comparator minimum.

Option A — Coastal / bayside

1. Frankston — nature-first anchor
2. Springvale — community-first comparator
3. Endeavour Hills — Potential both
4. Seaford — nature-first anchor

Option B — Hills / forest

1. Seaford — nature-first anchor
2. Clayton South — community-first comparator
3. Endeavour Hills — Potential both
4. Wheelers Hill — Potential both; price caveat

Option C — Green / family access

1. Mordialloc — nature-first anchor
2. Keysborough — community-first comparator
3. Wheelers Hill — Potential both; price caveat
4. Endeavour Hills — Potential both

Rule check	A — Coastal / bayside	B — Hills / forest	C — Green / family access
Nature-first anchor (at least 1)	Frankston, Seaford (2)	Seaford (1)	Mordialloc (1)
Community comparators (at least 2)	Springvale, Endeavour Hills (2)	Clayton South, Endeavour Hills, Wheelers Hill (3)	Keysborough, Wheelers Hill, Endeavour Hills (3)
Community-first comparator	Springvale	Clayton South	Keysborough
Checked Potential-both (at least 1)	Endeavour Hills	Endeavour Hills, Wheelers Hill	Wheelers Hill, Endeavour Hills
Comparators meet price cap, Glen Waverley limit and public 24-hour ED	Yes (CHECKED)	Yes (CHECKED)	Yes (CHECKED)
Meets the rule	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**

The eight suburbs at a glance. Anchors carry a workbook rank; comparators are not ranked. Glen Waverley and ED minutes are the workbook's (J and K), shown with their basis; do not compare across bases.

Suburb	Role (options)	Workbook status	Glen Waverley min (basis)	Public 24-hour ED, min	House price (evidence)	Community band (India-born / other language)	Nature (evidence)
Frankston	Nature-first anchor (A)	Provisional pass, rank 1, score 7.00	25 (Leave now, 26 Oct)	Peninsula University Hospital, 4	$834,296 sale median (CHECKED)	Low (1.1% / 12.1%)	Nature 6, Beach 8 (ESTIMATE); Bunarong Park, Sweetwater Creek and Paratea reserves (CHECKED, Wikipedia, workbook C3 note)
Mordialloc	Nature-first anchor (C)	Provisional pass, rank 2, score 6.90	28 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	Sandringham Hospital, 14 (24 hours per Alfred Health, workbook note)	$1,401,241 AVM (ESTIMATE); 6.6% under the cap	Low (1.4% / 18.7%)	Nature 5, Beach 9 (ESTIMATE); beach and pier (CHECKED, Wikipedia)
Seaford	Nature-first anchor (A, B)	Provisional pass, rank 3, score 6.89	24 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	Peninsula University Hospital, 8	$861,235 AVM (ESTIMATE)	Low (0.6% / 9.6%)	Nature 6, Beach 9 (ESTIMATE); foreshore reserve, 305 ha wetlands, Kananook Creek corridor (CHECKED)
Springvale	Community-first comparator (A)	Comparator, not ranked	26 (10:00 weekday, 28 Oct)	Monash Medical Centre Clayton, 18 (10:00 weekday)	$942,500 SOI median (CHECKED)	High (7.4% / 76%)	None of size (CHECKED)
Clayton South	Community-first comparator (B)	Comparator, not ranked	35 (10:00 weekday, 28 Oct)	Monash Medical Centre Clayton, 12 (10:00 weekday)	$985,000 SOI median (CHECKED)	High (14.9% / 67%)	Golf courses, landfill; no reserve named (CHECKED)
Keysborough	Community-first comparator (C)	Comparator, not ranked	24 (10:00 weekday, 28 Oct)	Dandenong Hospital, 18 (10:00 weekday)	$975,000 SOI median (CHECKED)	High (6.6% / 61%)	Market gardens to the south; no reserve named (CHECKED)
Endeavour Hills	Potential both (A, B, C)	Comparator, not ranked	26 (10:00 weekday, 28 Oct)	Dandenong Hospital, 12 (10:00 weekday)	$857,000 SOI median (CHECKED)	High (4.6% / 51%)	James Alexander Reserve 3 min; Churchill NP 8–10; Lysterfield Park 12 (CHECKED)
Wheelers Hill	Potential both; price caveat (B, C)	Comparator, not ranked; suitable-property verification outstanding	12 (10:00 weekday, 28 Oct)	Dandenong Hospital, 18 (10:00 weekday)	$1,475,000 SOI median, 1.7% under the cap; budget CHECKED from Jellis Craig sold results	Medium (4.1% / 46%)	Jells Park (~127 ha) 6 min (CHECKED)

What each option shows.

- **A — Coastal / bayside** sets the two ends side by side: the workbook's 1st and 3rd suburbs (both Low on community, Beach 8–9) against Springvale, the most multicultural comparator (76% other language at home), with Endeavour Hills as the one middle case. It has the starkest contrast and only one compromise suburb.
- **B — Hills / forest** has the strongest Indian-community comparator in any option (Clayton South, India-born 14.9%, grocer 4–6 min, temple 7–12 min) and both Potential-both suburbs. Its only anchor is Seaford. Note that none of its four suburbs is a hills or forest suburb in the workbook's sense: Endeavour Hills (bush reserve, Churchill NP 8–10 min) and Wheelers Hill (Jells Park) are the greenest.
- **C — Green / family access** has the shortest drives to family (Wheelers Hill 12 min, 10:00 weekday; Mordialloc 28 min, leave now) and both Potential-both suburbs. Its anchor, Mordialloc, has the lowest Nature score of the three anchors (5) and an AVM price near the cap; Keysborough is the lighter community-first comparator (India-born 6.6%, temple 14–20 min).

Price caveat (Wheelers Hill). The SOI median is $1,475,000, 1.7% under the $1.5M cap. Jellis Craig sold results (data to 6 Sep 2026) show three houses sold under the cap (8 Bottlebrush Ct $1,215,000, 27 Aug 2026; 4 Locum Ct $1,224,500; 81 Cootamundra Dr $1,130,000; report median $1.46M) (Jellis Craig). This supports looking further; it does not show that a suitable house is available. Suitable-property verification is outstanding for **every** suburb in every option.

Five things to know before reading on
1. **Prices for ranked suburbs are mostly AVMs.** 38 of 51 workbook prices are automated estimates, not sale medians (7 are sale medians, 5 are 3-bed medians, 1 is a 5-sale median). The six comparators use Statement of Information sale medians (CHECKED).
2. **Hazard overlays are unchecked for every suburb.** Only council-wide lists and news items were read; none at property level.
3. **Indian groceries, temples and churches are CHECKED for the six Community comparators** (current Google listings and drive times, 28 Oct), except two items that NEED VERIFICATION (Endeavour Spices; Shri Sanatan Dharam's opening hours). For the 51 ranked suburbs the notes name a few temples but no grocers, and the workbook's Indian-community scores (P) are ESTIMATE.
4. **Twelve suburbs are not ranked:** four "needs data" because the price is over the cap or unclear (Blackburn $1.60M sale median; Glen Waverley $1.675M sale median, baseline only; Williamstown $1.64M AVM, sale medians $1.49M to $1.58M; Mount Eliza $1.61M AVM, Jellis Craig median $1.72M) and eight fail the 90-minute Glen Waverley limit (Ocean Grove 92, Clifton Springs 95, Inverloch 96, Trentham 97, Curlewis 104, Ballarat 111, Castlemaine 114, Bendigo 140).
5. **No suitable property has been verified for any suburb.** A suburb median, or the Wheelers Hill sold results, shows that houses trade under the cap; it does not show that one meets the family's needs.

Community comparators: the other side of the trade-off (added 28 Oct 2026)

Why they are here. On the band thresholds below, 48 of the 51 ranked suburbs would be Low on community; only Berwick, Ringwood and West Footscray would reach Medium (ABS 2021, workbook columns AQ, AU and AX). The three anchors are all Low. The comparators let the family see what "Indian shops and community in your own suburb, less green" (Q13 option A) looks like. They are **not ranked and not meant to win**: they carry only the three formula scores (Near family, Hospital, Price), so the workbook gives them no weighted score. No overall winner is declared.

Community band (display-only; workbook column AX). High: other language at home 50% or more, or India-born 8% or more. Medium: 30–49%, or India-born 4–7.9%. Low: everything else. These ABS 2021 shares describe who lives in a suburb; they do not measure belonging or community quality. The band is not used by any score or weight.

Basis. All figures CHECKED unless marked. Drives (Glen Waverley and ED): **10:00 weekday, 28 Oct** (Google Maps "Depart at" Wed 28 Oct 2026 10:00, typical-traffic range, suburb centre to destination); the top of the range is the workbook figure (J, K) and is tested against the 90-min cap. The 08:00 column is context only: Peak (08:00), not used in the workbook J/K figures. ED: public hospital (Victorian Department of Health list) and open 24 hours (healthdirect, Mercy Health). Price: "Median price, house" from a Victorian Statement of Information (SOI). Places: current Google Business listings with hours, phone or reviews.

Suburb	Corner	Band (India-born / other language)	House price (SOI median)	Glen Waverley, 10:00 weekday, 28 Oct: workbook J (range)	Peak (08:00), not used in the workbook J/K figures	Public 24-hour ED, 10:00 weekday: workbook K (range)	Indian grocery	Hindu temple	Church	Nature
Springvale	Diverse / lower-green	High (7.4% / 76%)	$942,500 (Jul 2025–Jun 2026)	26 (10–26)	10–35	Monash Medical Centre Clayton 18 (10–18)	India Town, 11b/310 Springvale Rd, 4	Sankat Mochan Hanuman Mandir, Oakleigh South, 10–20	St Joseph's Catholic, 4	None of size
Clayton South	Diverse / lower-green	High (14.9% / 67%)	$985,000 (Apr 2025–Mar 2026)	35 (14–35)	16–40	Monash Medical Centre Clayton 12 (8–12)	Little India Mart, 2/1310 Centre Rd, 4–6; Sarawan Spices, Clayton, 5–8	Sankat Mochan, 7–12	St Andrew's Catholic, 76 Springs Rd, 5	Golf courses, landfill; no reserve named
Keysborough	Diverse / lower-green	High (6.6% / 61%)	$975,000 (Jul 2025–Jun 2026)	24 (18–24)	18–30	Dandenong Hospital 18 (12–18)	India at Home, Parkmore SC, 4–6	Shri Shiva Vishnu, Carrum Downs, 14–20 (gurdwara in suburb)	Church of the Resurrection, 5–6	Market gardens to the south; no reserve named

Suburb	Corner	Band (India-born / other language)	House price (SOI median)	Glen Waverley, 10:00 weekday, 28 Oct: workbook J (range)	Peak (08:00), not used in the workbook J/K figures	Public 24-hour ED, 10:00 weekday: workbook K (range)	Indian grocery	Hindu temple	Church	Nature
Clyde North	Diverse / lower-green	High (18.2% / 54%)	$752,932 (Jun 2025–May 2026)	50 (28–50)	35–70	Casey Hospital, Berwick 24 (12–24)	Wirsa Indian Groceries, Selandra Blvd, 2	Shrinathji Haveli, Hallam, 16–30 (BAPS, Smiths Ln, 8–12 ESTIMATE)	St Thomas the Apostle, 5 Fiorelli Blvd, 4	Farmland; regional park only proposed
Endeavour Hills	Potential both	High (4.6% / 51%)	$857,000 (Aug 2025–Aug 2026)	26 (16–26)	18–35	Dandenong Hospital 12 (7–12)	India At Home, Dandenong Plaza, 8–12 (Endeavour Spices: NEEDS VERIFICATION)	Shrinathji Haveli, Hallam, 8–14 (confirmed temple); Shri Sanatan Dharam, Hallam North Rd, opening hours NEED VERIFICATION, 4–6 ESTIMATE	St Paul Apostle Catholic, 2	James Alexander Reserve (Casuarina Forest) 1.1 km / 3 min; Churchill NP 8–10; Lysterfield Park 12
Wheelers Hill	Potential both (community lighter)	Medium (4.1% / 46%)	$1,475,000 (Jun 2025–Jun 2026), 1.7% under cap; budget CHECKED (Jellis Craig sold results); suitable-property verification outstanding	12 (7–12)	4–12	Dandenong Hospital 18 (12–18)	The Heritage Spices, 580 Ferntree Gully Rd, 6–9	Shree Swaminarayan, Boronia, 10–20	St Justin's Catholic, 4	Jells Park (~127 ha) 2.6 km / 6 min

Drive figures are minutes. **Anchors for comparison** (workbook, all Low): Frankston (India-born 1.1%, other language 12.1%), Mordialloc (1.4% / 18.7%), Seaford (0.6% / 9.6%). **Reference only:** Rowville (3.2% / 32%, Medium; Churchill National Park edge; drives, ED and price not checked, ESTIMATE). Rowville is not in the scorecard or any option.

Not comparators. These are not Community comparators, not in the scorecard and not in any option.

Suburb	Status	Why	Glen Waverley, 10:00 weekday, 28 Oct	Peak (08:00), not used in the workbook J/K figures
Point Cook	**Conditional**	Fails the verified 90-minute Glen Waverley journey at 08:00 peak. Its inclusion would require a family decision to accept a longer travel trade-off.	45–70	55–100
Tarneit	**Excluded**	Excluded — family decision 28 Oct 2026 (stated reasons: safety concerns and not enough going for it). This is the family's stated view, not a checked fact; Tarneit passes the 90-min cap at 10:00.	50–80 (passes the 90-min cap)	60–110 (context only; not the reason)
Mount Waverley	**Excluded**	Median over the $1.5M cap	not used	not used

Under-cap evidence (not the median alone). SOI ranges or comparable sales under $1.5M are CHECKED for Springvale ($720k–$790k), Clayton South ($1.00–1.08M), Keysborough ($1.05–1.155M), Clyde North ($790–860k) and Endeavour Hills ($760–820k). Wheelers Hill: budget CHECKED from the Jellis Craig sold results above. Whether a *suitable* house (single level or adaptable, enough bedrooms) exists under the cap is **not yet checked for any comparator**; that is a listings-stage job.

One line each (trade-off).

- **Springvale:** the most diverse (76% other language), grocer and church in walking range, 26 min to family (10:00 weekday); little nature.
- **Clayton South:** high India-born share and the closest major ED (8–12 min); a sand-belt suburb with little nature.
- **Keysborough:** grocer, church and gurdwara local, the large Shiva Vishnu temple 14–20 min; on the side towards the bay; little bush.

- **Clyde North:** cheapest, grocer 2 min; new estates, and the furthest of the six (50 min at 10:00 weekday; the peak (08:00) top of 70 min, context only, would exceed a 60-min preference). In no option.
- **Endeavour Hills:** the strongest "both" case: bush reserve walkable from central streets, national park 10 min, grocer, confirmed temple (Shrinathji Haveli) and church within about 15 min, ED 7–12.
- **Wheelers Hill:** next to family (12 min, 10:00 weekday) and a 127 ha park; dearest (1.7% under the cap), and only Medium on community. Budget CHECKED; suitable-property verification outstanding.

Still to verify. Endeavour Spices (Endeavour Hills) is not on Google Maps, so India At Home in Dandenong is used instead: NEEDS VERIFICATION. Shri Sanatan Dharam Society (Hallam North Rd) has no opening hours listed, and its registered address is Narre Warren North, so its hours NEED VERIFICATION and the 4–6 min drive is an ESTIMATE. Train access for the comparators is from recall (Springvale and Clayton South yes; the other four no): ESTIMATE. Hazard overlays are unchecked, as for every suburb. Full evidence and links: `Community comparators — research (28 Oct 2026).md`.

Workbook ranking: the top 15

All scores are the workbook's own (SuburbScorecard column X, rank column Y, passing rows only). Nat, Vil, Bch, Shp, Ind and Train score are ESTIMATE. Scores within about 0.05 are ties in practice (Heidelberg 7.26 and Mentone 7.26).

Rank	Suburb	Score	GW min (basis)	ED min	Nat	Vil	Bch	Shp	Ind	Train score
1	Frankston	7.91	25 (Leave now, 26 Oct)	4	6	3	10	9	5.7	9
2	Berwick	7.56	25 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	6	5	6	6	9	8.4	8
3	West Footscray	7.47	39 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	6	2	5	10	8	6.9	8
4	Newport	7.39	35 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	14	5	6	10	7	4.9	9
5	Seaford	7.30	24 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	8	6	4	10	7	4.8	8
6	Altona	7.27	35 (Leave now, 26 Oct)	15	4	6	10	8	5.1	8
7	Heidelberg	7.26	25 (Leave now, 26 Oct)	4	6	4	6	8	6.9	8
7	Mentone	7.26	25 (Leave now, 26 Oct)	16	4	6	10	9	4	8
9	Ringwood	7.22	12 (Leave now, 26 Oct)	5	4	3	4	10	7	9
10	Rosanna	7.16	34 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	8	7	6	6	7	6.6	8
11	Ferntree Gully	7.06	14 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	8	6	4	6	8	5.8	8
12	Mordialloc	7.02	28 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	14	5	7	10	8	2.5	8
13	Croydon	6.91	18 (Leave now, 26 Oct)	6	5	4	4	9	6.4	8
14	Chelsea	6.82	30 (Leave now, 27 Oct)	19	4	5	10	8	2.9	8
15	Upwey	6.73	17 (Leave now, 26 Oct)	4	9	8	6	5	3.2	8

Master comparison: 51 suburbs (37 ranked after the 2 Nov 2026 scoring change), grouped by region

Key. Rg = region (DAN Dandenong foothills and ridge, YV Yarra Valley, NE north-east and inner-east, BAY bayside and south-east, PEN Mornington Peninsula, WST west coast, MAC Macedon Ranges, GEE Geelong and Surf Coast, GIP Gippsland). Opt = in viewing option A, B or C. Price = workbook house price plus basis: **S** sale median, **A** AVM (automated estimate, not a sale; ESTIMATE), **3B** 3-bed house median (Domain), **S5** median of only 5 sales. † = an independent source disagrees by 8% or more, or on a different basis (see disagreements). ‡ = identical AVM for Ferntree Gully and Upper Ferntree Gully (duplicate). GW = workbook drive minutes to Glen Waverley, with the basis label; ED = workbook drive minutes to the 24-hour ED it used; **!** = that ED is the

nearest, not a major ED (Rosebud); **?** = researchers flagged the figure. Train = station in or beside suburb (workbook, from recall; Y includes slow V/Line services). Nat, Vil, Bch, Shp, Ind = the workbook's Nature, Village, Beach, Shops and doctor and Indian-community scores, 0 to 10, all **ESTIMATE**. Workbook score (rank) = SuburbScorecard X and Y. Hazard: F fire, W flood, C coast, I industry or noise; H, M, L = researcher's rough level; * = a checked source names the hazard. All hazard levels are unverified at property level.

Suburb	Rg	Opt	House price & basis	GW min	GW drive basis	ED min	Train	Nat	Vil	Bch	Shp	Ind	Workbook score (rank)	Hazard
DANDENONG FOOTHILLS AND RIDGE	DAN													
Upper Ferntree Gully	DAN	–	$872k A ‡	16	Leave now, 26 Oct	2	Y	8	5	6	6	3.8	6.65 (#16)	F-H*
Ferntree Gully	DAN	–	$872k A ‡	14	Leave now, 27 Oct	8	Y	6	4	6	8	5.8	7.06 (#11)	F-M
Upwey	DAN	–	$930k S	17	Leave now, 26 Oct	4	Y	9	8	6	5	3.2	6.73 (#15)	F-H*
Tecoma	DAN	–	$894k A	19	Leave now, 26 Oct	5	Y	9	6	6	4	2.2	6.15 (#22)	F-H*
Belgrave	DAN	–	$856k A	21	Leave now, 26 Oct	7	Y	9	8	4	6	1.5	6.10 (#23)	F-H*
The Basin	DAN	–	$845k A	17	Leave now, 26 Oct	10	N	8	7	4	4	4.5	5.44 (#29)	F-H
Montrose	DAN	–	$968k A	22	Leave now, 26 Oct	12	N	8	6	4	5	4.3	5.44 (#28)	F-H*
Mount Evelyn	DAN	–	$915k A	27	Leave now, 26 Oct	17	N	8	6	4	5	2.9	5.12 (#32)	F-H*
Olinda	DAN	–	$1.02M A	33	Leave now, 27 Oct	15	N	10	9	4	3	1.7	4.78 (#34)	F-H
Sassafras	DAN	–	$1.01M A	29	Leave now, 27 Oct	11	N	10	9	4	3	2	4.93 (#33)	F-H
Mount Dandenong	DAN	–	$982k A	30	Leave now, 27 Oct	19	N	10	7	4	2	2.4	4.45 (#35)	F-H
Emerald	DAN	–	$981k A	35	Leave now, 27 Oct	22	N	9	8	4	6	0.9	4.85 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	F-H
YARRA VALLEY	YV													
Warburton	YV	–	$718k 3B	65	Leave now, 27 Oct	53?	N	10	8	0	4	0.2	3.05 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	F-H, W-M
Healesville	YV	–	$838k A	43	Leave now, 26 Oct	33?	N	9	8	0	6	0.1	3.87 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	F-H, W-M
Yarra Glen	YV	–	$936k A	44	Leave now, 27 Oct	30?	N	7	7	2	5	0.9	3.78 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	F-M, W-M
NORTH-EAST AND INNER-EAST	NE													
Ringwood	NE	–	$1.04M S	12	Leave now, 26 Oct	5	Y	4	3	4	10	7	7.22 (#9)	W-L
Croydon	NE	–	$899k A	18	Leave now, 26 Oct	6	Y	5	4	4	9	6.4	6.91 (#13)	F-L
Heidelberg	NE	–	$1.45M S	25	Leave now, 26 Oct	4	Y	6	4	6	8	6.9	7.26 (#7)	W-M
Rosanna	NE	–	$1.24M A	34	Leave now, 27 Oct	8	Y	7	6	6	7	6.6	7.16 (#10)	W-M
Eltham	NE	–	$1.27M S	26	Leave now, 26 Oct	16	Y	8	7	4	8	1.6	6.28 (#20)	F-H, W-M
Diamond Creek	NE	–	$885k 3B	33	Leave now, 26 Oct	19	Y	7	6	4	7	2	5.80 (#26)	F-H*, W-M*
Warrandyte	NE	–	$1.35M A	20	Leave now, 26 Oct	14	N	9	8	4	6	2.8	5.50 (#27)	F-H*, W-M*
Hurstbridge	NE	–	$981k A	41	Leave now, 27 Oct	29	Y	8	8	2	5	1	4.84 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	F-H, W-M
BAYSIDE AND SOUTH-EAST	BAY													
Mentone	BAY	–	$1.497M S †	25	Leave now, 26 Oct	16	Y	4	6	10	9	4	7.26 (#7)	C-M
Mordialloc	BAY	C	$1.40M A	28	Leave now, 27 Oct	14	Y	5	7	10	8	2.5	7.02 (#12)	W-M, C-M

Suburb	Rg	Opt	House price & basis	GW min	GW drive basis	ED min	Train	Nat	Vil	Bch	Shp	Ind	Workbook score (rank)	Hazard
Chelsea	BAY	–	$1.16M A	30	Leave now, 27 Oct	19	Y	4	5	10	8	2.9	6.82 (#14)	C-M, W-M
Seaford	BAY	AB	$861k A	24	Leave now, 27 Oct	8	Y	6	4	10	7	4.8	7.30 (#5)	W-M
Frankston	BAY	A	$834k S	25	Leave now, 26 Oct	4	Y	6	3	10	9	5.7	7.91 (#1)	C-M, W-M
Frankston South	BAY	–	$1.20M A	31	Leave now, 27 Oct	4?	N	7	5	10	5	5	6.55 (#19)	F-M
Berwick	BAY	–	$936k A	25	Leave now, 27 Oct	6	Y	5	6	6	9	8.4	7.56 (#2)	F-M
MORNINGTON PENINSULA	PEN													
Mornington	PEN	–	$1.10M A †	40	Leave now, 26 Oct	15	N	6	7	10	9	1.9	6.22 (#21)	C-M
Mount Martha	PEN	–	$1.34M A	47	Leave now, 27 Oct	19	N	8	7	10	5	0.1	5.24 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	C-M
Arthurs Seat	PEN	–	$1.43M S5	52	Leave now, 27 Oct	13!	N	9	4	10	2	0	4.64 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	F-H*
Dromana	PEN	–	$906k A	47	Leave now, 27 Oct	11!	N	7	6	10	6	0.2	5.43 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	F-H, C-M
McCrae	PEN	–	$959k A	49	Leave now, 27 Oct	6!	N	8	6	10	4	0	5.26 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	C-M, F-M
Rosebud	PEN	–	$754k A	49	Leave now, 27 Oct	3!	N	6	4	10	9	0.3	5.83 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	C-M
Rye	PEN	–	$918k A	61	Leave now, 27 Oct	9!	N	7	7	10	6	0.1	5.37 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	C-M, W-M
WEST COAST	WST													
Altona	WST	–	$1.16M A †	35	Leave now, 26 Oct	15	Y	4	6	10	8	5.1	7.27 (#6)	C-M, I-M
Newport	WST	–	$1.15M A	35	Leave now, 27 Oct	14	Y	5	6	10	7	4.9	7.39 (#4)	W-M, I-M
West Footscray	WST	–	$1.05M A	39	Leave now, 27 Oct	6	Y	2	5	10	8	6.9	7.47 (#3)	I-M, W-L
MACEDON RANGES	MAC													
Kyneton	MAC	–	$810k 3B	77	Leave now, 26 Oct	47	Y	7	9	0	7	0.3	4.05 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	F-M*, W-L
Woodend	MAC	–	$890k 3B †	68	Leave now, 26 Oct	55	Y	8	9	2	6	0.9	4.30 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	F-H
Macedon	MAC	–	$1.15M A †	62	Leave now, 26 Oct	60	Y	9	8	2	3	2.1	4.00 (#37)	F-H*
Gisborne	MAC	–	$1.04M A	67	Leave now, 27 Oct	34	Y	7	7	4	7	3.6	5.19 (#31)	F-M, W-M
Riddells Creek	MAC	–	$994k A	71	Leave now, 27 Oct	38	Y	7	7	2	4	3	4.38 (#36)	F-M
GEELONG AND SURF COAST	GEE													
Newtown (Geelong)	GEE	–	$1.18M A †	72	Leave now, 26 Oct	7	N	5	6	10	8	5.4	6.62 (#17)	W-M
Highton (Geelong)	GEE	–	$958k A †	74	Leave now, 26 Oct	9	N	6	5	10	8	6.1	6.57 (#18)	F-M, W-M
Torquay	GEE	–	$1.18M S †	88	Leave now, 26 Oct	23	N	7	5	10	8	2.9	5.96 (#24)	F-M, W-M
GIPPSLAND	GIP													
Warragul	GIP	–	$620k 3B	58	Leave now, 26 Oct	2?	Y	5	6	2	8	5.6	5.94 (#25)	F-M, W-M
Drouin	GIP	–	$702k A	57	Leave now, 27 Oct	9	Y	5	6	2	7	3.9	5.26 (#30)	F-M, W-M
Wonthaggi	GIP	–	$588k A †	88	Leave now, 27 Oct	3	N	6	5	10	7	0.5	5.22 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive)	C-M, F-M

The six Community comparators are not in this table: they are display-only and not ranked (see the section above). Synthetic test rows are excluded. Sources for the price column are OnTheHouse/ Cotality, Domain and similar, mostly 30 Sep 2026.

How the workbook score works

Formula (workbook column X). Weighted score = sum of (criterion score × final weight) over ten criteria, on a 0 to 10 scale. A row gets a score only when all ten criterion scores are entered, and a rank (column Y) only when its hard-filter status contains "pass". Near family = 10 × (1 − Glen Waverley minutes ÷ 90); Hospital = 10 × (1 − ED minutes ÷ 90); Price = 10 at $500k or less, falling to 0 at the $1.5M cap. The other seven scores are researcher estimates (ESTIMATE).

Final weights (workbook ForcedChoiceCorrections). Survey weight from the Q15 ratings, plus the trade-off correction (winner moved 2 points ahead of loser), renormalised.

Criterion	Survey weight %	Trade-off correction (points)	Final weight %
Beach	12.3	+4.1 (Q11: Beach over Nature, 2–1)	16.4
Nature	18.5	−4.1 (Q11)	14.4
Train/bus	12.0	0	12.0
Village character	6.0	+5.9 (Q12: Village over Shops, 2–1)	11.9
Hospital	11.6	0	11.6
Shops & doctor	15.7	−5.9 (Q12)	9.9
Indian community	7.9	0 (Q13: Nature over Indian community, 2–1; Nature already ahead)	7.9
Price	6.0	0	6.0
Near family in Glen Waverley	5.8	0 (Q10: Nature over Near family, 2–1; Nature already ahead)	5.8
City trip	4.2	0	4.2

Worked example (Frankston). Near family 7.2 × 5.8% + Nature 6 × 14.4% + Hospital 9.6 × 11.6% + Indian 4 × 7.9% + Shops 9 × 9.9% + Village 3 × 11.9% + Train 9 × 12.0% + Price 6.7 × 6.0% + Beach 8 × 16.4% + City trip 6 × 4.2% = **7.00**.

Why the top is bayside. Beach (16.4%) is now the largest weight, and seven of the top eight have Beach 8 or 9 (Newport, 8th, has 4). Near family carries only 5.8%, so a short drive to Glen Waverley adds little. Nature carries 14.4%, but the greenest suburbs score low on Beach (0), Shops and Train, so they rank 35th or lower. The 27 Oct sensitivity tables (original survey weights, rule-recomputed weights, Nature at 30%) were calculated on the earlier provisional scores and weights; they have been removed and **not re-run** on the workbook.

Researcher limits. Seven researchers scored with one rubric but no cross-calibration. Each estimate is one person's judgement from thin sources. Treat gaps under about 0.5 points as noise.

Profile cards

Each card separates **Checked** facts (with links) from **Estimate**. Card headers show region, price and basis, Glen Waverley minutes with the drive basis, ED minutes, train and the workbook score and rank. Scores quoted in cards are the workbook's. The six comparators are summarised in their own section above.

The three nature-first anchors

Frankston · BAY · $834,296 (S) · GW 25 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 4 · train Y · workbook 7.91 (#1) **Checked:** rail terminus of the Frankston and Stony Point lines and a bus hub (workbook, Wikipedia); Peninsula University Hospital runs a 24-hour ED (Peninsula Health); India-born 1.1%, other language at home 12.1% (ABS 2021, workbook) (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 6, Village 3, Beach 10, Shops 9, Indian 5.7; central Frankston has mixed amenity; Frankston South is its greener counterpart. **Trade-off:** the workbook's top score and the cheapest bayside sale median; a busy regional centre rather than a village.

Mordialloc · BAY · $1,401,241 (A) · GW 28 (Leave now, 27 Oct) · ED 14 · train Y · workbook 7.02 (#12) **Checked:** station on the Frankston line; beach and pier (workbook, Wikipedia); Sandringham Hospital ED open 24 hours, 7 days (Alfred Health, workbook note); India-born 1.4%, other language at home 18.7% (ABS 2021, workbook) (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 5, Village 7, Beach 10, Shops 8, Indian 2.5; the price is an AVM 6.6% under the cap. **Trade-off:** the strongest village feel of the bayside suburbs, on rail; the least green anchor, and the price is close to the cap.

Seaford · BAY · $861,235 (A) · GW 24 (Leave now, 27 Oct) · ED 8 · train Y · workbook 7.30 (#5) **Checked:** Kananook Creek Reserve is a 7.5 km corridor linking Seaford Wetlands to the Frankston foreshore (Frankston Council). 74.2% Australia-born; India not in the top responses (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 6, Village 4, Beach 10; flat, easy walking; creek-corridor flood overlay possible. **Trade-off:** the cheapest credible bay-plus-creek suburb with a train, inside Mum's 25-minute limit; ordinary shops and almost no Indian community.

Other profile cards (27 Oct research; not in a viewing option)

Dandenong foothills and ridge

Upwey · DAN · $929,500 (S, 104 sales) · GW 17 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 4 · train Y · workbook 6.73 (#15) **Checked:** Domain's 2026 page lists a 3-bed house at $860k and a 4-bed at $1.07m, in line with the workbook (Domain). Main Street sits beside the station with small shops, health services, cafes and the Burrinja Cultural Centre; Birdsland Reserve and the Ringwood–Belgrave Rail Trail are in the township (Wikipedia). Named in the Oct 2017 bushfire overlay update (Star Mail). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 9, Village 8, Shops 5, Indian 3.2. Supermarket and pharmacy not confirmed; hilly streets and many split-level homes; nearest temple (The Basin) about 15 min. **Trade-off:** the best village-plus-train-plus-closeness mix in the hills; costs are the fire overlay and a thin Indian community.

Belgrave · DAN · $856,437 (A) · GW 21 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 7 · train Y (terminus) · workbook 6.10 (#23) **Checked:** Belgrave Lake Park, Borthwick Park, Dandenong Ranges National Park, Monbulk Creek and Puffing Billy; main street with galleries and bookshops behind the station (Wikipedia). 78.8% Australia-born, India below 0.7% (not in the top five) (ABS); 99.2% separate houses (gdp.com.au); on the 2017 bushfire overlay list. **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 9, Village 8, Shops 6 (supermarket and GP 5 to 10 min, unverified), Indian 1.5; steep in parts; 55 to 65 min by train to the city. **Trade-off:** the strongest forest village on rail within 21 minutes of family; weekend tourist crowds, fire exposure, AVM-only price.

Upper Ferntree Gully · DAN · $872,133 (A, duplicate) · GW 16 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 2 · train Y · workbook 6.65 (#16) **Checked:** adjoins Dandenong Ranges National Park, with the Kokoda Trail memorial walk and the "1000 steps"; own station since 1889 (Wikipedia). About 3,400 people, 96.1% separate houses, India-born 1.0% (34 people), median age 41 (ABS). On the 2017 bushfire overlay list. **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 8, Village 5, Shops 6 (supermarkets in Ferntree Gully 5 to 8 min), Indian 3.8; steep on the park side; single-level homes scarce on slopes. **Trade-off:** forest at the door, 16 minutes to Glen Waverley; the price may be a postcode-level AVM shared with Ferntree Gully.

Sassafras · DAN · $1,006,318 (A; thin sales) · GW 29 (Leave now, 27 Oct) · ED 11 · train N · workbook 4.93 (#33) **Checked:** village on a saddle of the ridge at about 500 m; much of the western locality is in Dandenong Ranges National Park; the 15 km Tourist Track follows Sassafras Creek; fire history to 1962 (Wikipedia). Population 970; 76.8% Australia-born; 354 dwellings, 98.6% separate (ABS); Belgrave (6 km) has the everyday shops. **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 10, Village 9 (tourist-led), Shops 3; overlay likely over most of the locality; narrow roads; winter ice and tree fall. **Trade-off:** the best forest in the set; no everyday shops in the village, and thin, hard-to-price sales.

The Basin · DAN · $845,187 (A) · GW 17 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 10 · train N · workbook 5.44 (#29) **Checked:** Basin Triangle shops (two pubs, cafes, greengrocer, butcher, post office, gym) beside Dandenong Ranges National Park and Doongalla Forest; no supermarket or pharmacy listed; bus 755 to Bayswater, Boronia and Ferntree Gully stations (Wikipedia). The Sri Vakrathunda Vinayagar Hindu temple is in the suburb (Sukkar release). India below 0.8% (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 8, Village 7, Shops 4 (supermarkets 8 to 12 min), Indian 4.5; steep roads. It is in Knox, not Yarra Ranges, so absence from the 2017 list is not evidence. **Trade-off:** forest plus a temple 17 minutes from family; car-dependent.

Mount Evelyn · DAN · $915,472 (A) · GW 27 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 17 · train N · workbook 5.12 (#32) **Checked:** Aqueduct Walk, the Lilydale–Warburton Rail Trail, and parts of the national park to the south; rail closed in 1965 (Wikipedia). Population 9,799; 85.6% Australia-born; India below 0.4%; 97.8% separate (ABS); on the 2017 overlay list. **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 8, Village 6, Shops 5 (not verified), Indian 2.9. **Trade-off:** flat rail-trail walking and forest; a low Indian-community score (2), no train, 27 minutes to family (Mum's limit is 25).

North-east and inner-east

Eltham · NE · $1,273,000 (S, 195 sales) · GW 26 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 16 · train Y · workbook 6.28 (#20) **Checked:** Alistair Knox Park, Barak Bushlands, Laughing Waters, the Diamond Creek Trail and Maroondah Aqueduct Trail; Main Road strip, Sunday farmers' market, station and SmartBus 902 (Wikipedia). 79.0% Australia-born, India below 0.7%, 85.9% separate houses (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 8, Village 7, Shops 8, Indian 1.6. Bushfire overlay likely over much of northern and eastern Eltham; many split-level mud-brick homes; Indian shops and temples 15 to 25 min away. **Trade-off:** the best all-round green village in the inner north-east; costs are stairs, fire and insurance, and weak Indian access.

Diamond Creek · NE · $885,000 (3B; 4-bed $1.24M) · GW 33 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 19 · train Y · workbook 5.80 (#26) **Checked:** the Diamond Creek Trail follows the creek and was extended to Hurstbridge in 2022; shopping centre on the creek bank; Hurstbridge-line station; repeated bushfires 1894 to 1969 and a floodplain are recorded (Wikipedia). 83.2% Australia-born, India 0.7% (87 people), 94.3% separate houses (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 7, Village 6, Shops 7, Indian 2; Hindu and Sikh sites 25+ min; Austin Hospital about 25 min. **Trade-off:** a cheaper green option with rail; the price is a 3-bed median, so a 4-bed is around $1.24M.

Warrandyte · NE · $1,348,901 (A) · GW 20 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 14 · train N · workbook 5.50 (#27) **Checked:** Warrandyte State Park, the Yarra gorge, Andersons Creek and Mullum Mullum Creek; Yarra Street centre; fires in 1939, 1962 and 2014 (Wikipedia). Manningham applied a new bushfire overlay to about 600 Wonga Park properties in 2023 (Manningham Council); VICSES lists Warrandyte among flood-risk locations (VICSES). 77.4% Australia-born, 98.4% separate (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 9, Village 8, Shops 6; steep driveways; the AVM probably understates large-block homes. **Trade-off:** top nature 20 minutes from family; the highest fire and insurance exposure in the north-east, and no train (direct city bus 906).

Hurstbridge · NE · $980,767 (A) · GW 41 (Leave now, 27 Oct) · ED 29 · train Y (terminus) · workbook 4.84 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive) **Checked:** more than 60 small businesses, a community hub, the 1912 terminus station, and the Diamond Creek Trail extended here in 2022 (Wikipedia). 86.1% Australia-born; India below 0.3%; 96.9% separate (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 8, Village 8, Shops 5; among the most fire-exposed on the list; larger supermarkets at Diamond Creek (about 8 min). **Trade-off:** a true bush village on rail; remote, with the weakest Indian access.

Croydon · NE · $898,896 (A) · GW 18 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 6 · train Y · workbook 6.91 (#13) **Checked:** 71.1% Australia-born, India 2.3% (665 people), 83.4% separate houses (ABS). Main Street, Croydon Central and Arndale; the station is under 5 min from Main Street, and Wikipedia noted a closure from March 2024 for level-crossing works (Wikipedia). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 5; foothills 10 to 15 min away; Maroondah Hospital about 10 min; Indian shops 15 to 25 min; station likely reopened, verify. **Trade-off:** a cheap "village plus train" option 18 minutes from family, with modest nature.

Bayside, south-east and Peninsula

Berwick · BAY · $935,845 (A) · GW 25 (Leave now, 27 Oct) · ED 6 · train Y · workbook 7.56 (#2) **Checked:** India-born 6.1%, Hinduism 5.5%, 62.3% Australia-born (ABS). Wilson Botanic Park: 39 ha, two former quarry lakes, boardwalk and lookout tower (Wikipedia). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 5 (parks, not forest), Village 6 (historic village, hilltop feel), Indian 8.4, Shops 9; Casey Hospital ED (workbook; 24-hour status from recall); fringe fire overlay; busy Princes Highway. **Trade-off:** the highest India-born share of the ranked top 10 (6.1%) with strong services; little forest and no beach.

Frankston South · BAY · $1,195,044 (A) · GW 31 (Leave now, 27 Oct) · ED 4? · train N · workbook 6.55 (#19) **Checked:** Sweetwater Creek Upper Nature Reserve is a 5.3 ha bushland strip (Frankston Council); Frankston's Peninsula University Hospital runs a 24-hour ED (Peninsula Health). India-born 0.9% (169 people), median age 44 (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 7, Village 5 (small strips only), Beach 10, Shops 5; hilly; the 4-minute ED time looks optimistic (guess 8 to 12); many older single-level homes. **Trade-off:** the only candidate offering creek bush and the bay together; no station and no village centre.

Mornington · PEN · $1,096,505 (A); Jellis Craig house median $1.20m · GW 40 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 15 · train N · workbook 6.22 (#21) **Checked:** Jellis Craig puts the house median at $1.20m (1 Aug 2026), 9% above the workbook AVM (Jellis Craig). Buses 781, 784 and 785 together give a 20-minute service to Frankston (Transport Victoria). Population 25,759; 74.0% Australia-born; India not in the top six; 77.0% separate houses (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 6, Village 7 (Main Street is a real centre), Beach 10, Shops 9; Frankston ED about 20 min; foreshore flooding in low pockets. **Trade-off:** the best bay-town services; busier, less forest, no train.

Mount Martha · PEN · $1,344,095 (A); Jellis Craig house median $1.40m · GW 47 (Leave now, 27 Oct) · ED 19 (Rosebud) · train N · workbook 5.24 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive) **Checked:** the Jellis Craig median is $1.40m (6 Sep 2026), close to the cap (Jellis Craig); route 781 runs hourly (Transport Victoria); 76.4% Australia-born, 84.2% separate houses (ABS). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 8 (Mount Martha Park, Balcombe Estuary), Beach 10, Shops 5; Frankston ED about 25 min; split-level bay-view homes. **Trade-off:** leafy bay living at the top of the budget, with an hourly bus.

Dromana · PEN · $906,318 (A); Jellis Craig house median $965,000 · GW 47 (Leave now, 27 Oct) · ED 11! · train N · workbook 5.43 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive) **Checked:** Jellis Craig median $965,000 (6 Sep 2026) (Jellis Craig); route 781 ends here, hourly (Transport Victoria); 74.0% Australia-born, median age 50 (ABS). Rosebud Hospital ED is open 24 hours but treats moderate and minor cases; serious cases go to Frankston (Peninsula Health). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 7 (Arthurs Seat State Park behind), Beach 10; major ED about 40 min away; hillside fire overlay; low foreshore inundation. **Trade-off:** beach and hills together; a long way from a major ED and a seasonal feel.

Macedon, Geelong and Gippsland

Woodend · MAC · $890,000 (3B) · GW 68 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 55 · train Y · workbook 4.30 (not ranked: fails: grocery drive) **Checked:** population 6,732, 79.5% Australia-born, India not listed (so 0.7% or less) (ABS). Jellis Craig shows an all-house median of $1.04M (to 1 Jun 2026), well above the workbook's 3-bed $890k (Jellis Craig). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 8

(ranges forest a short drive away), Village 9 (walkable High Street), Shops 6, Indian 0.9; nearest 24-hour ED is Sunshine (about 70 km) or Bendigo (about 75 km); bushfire overlay over substantial areas; cold winters. **Trade-off:** forest-country village on the Bendigo line; 68 minutes to Glen Waverley is over the 60-minute preference.

Highton (Geelong) · GEE · $957,797 (A) · GW 74 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 9 · train N · workbook 6.57 (#18) **Checked:** population 20,736; India-born 2.4%, 77.3% Australia-born (ABS). PRD's Q2 2026 house median is $781,500 on 241 sales, about $175k below the workbook AVM (PRD). A Sri Sai Siva Vishnu Temple association is listed in the Geelong directory; address not retrieved (City of Greater Geelong). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 6 (Barrabool Hills, Barwon River), Village 5, Shops 8, Indian 6.1; University Hospital Geelong about 10 min; steep pockets; no local train. **Trade-off:** hills, an India-born share of 2.4% and strong services, but 74 minutes from family.

Torquay · GEE · $1,180,000 (S) · GW 88 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 23 · train N · workbook 5.96 (#24) **Checked:** patrolled Front Beach, sheltered Cosy Corner and the Surf Coast Walk (Great Ocean Road); population 18,534, 82.8% Australia-born (ABS); bus 54 runs to Marshall Station (McHarrys). A 2026 projection gives $1.05M, but the source is low quality (Collings). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Beach 10, Nature 7, Village 5; summer congestion; the ED time is optimistic but plausible off-peak. **Trade-off:** the one true surf-beach option; 88 minutes is effectively over the limit once traffic bites.

Warragul · GIP · $620,000 (3B; 4-bed $732.5k) · GW 58 (Leave now, 26 Oct) · ED 2? · train Y · workbook 5.94 (#25) **Checked:** population 19,856; India-born 1.0%; 81.0% Australia-born; median age 40 (ABS). House median $680,000 on 549 sales (Microburbs). V/Line to Southern Cross takes about 1 h 40 min, at least hourly (page dated Oct 2023) (Monash Rural Health). **Estimate (workbook scores and notes):** Nature 5 (rolling hills, forest 20 to 30 min away), Village 6, Shops 8, Indian 5.6; nearest Indian groceries 45 to 60 min; West Gippsland Hospital ED 24-hour status and waits not read directly. **Trade-off:** by far the cheapest credible option with a town centre; low Indian community and a long train.

The other 28 suburbs in one line each

Sorted by workbook rank.

Suburb (rank, score)	Note
West Footscray (#3, 7.47)	Nature 2; India-born 3.7% (SA2); industrial and truck traffic.
Newport (#4, 7.39)	Newport Lakes; industrial edges; Microburbs median $1.22M.
Altona (#6, 7.27)	Flat coast, 35 min cross-city; new Footscray Hospital opened 18 Feb 2026 (Vic Health); Microburbs median $1.25M vs AVM $1.155M.
Mentone (#7, 7.26)	$1,497,099 is $3k under the cap (Woodards shows $1.30m); flat, Nature 4; no 24-hour public ED in the suburb.
Heidelberg (#7, 7.26)	Austin Hospital precinct; only 42.3% separate houses; $1.452M on 35 sales is near the cap.
Ringwood (#9, 7.22)	Best logistics (12 min to family); mall and big-box feel, Nature 4; India-born 3.2% (618) (ABS).
Rosanna (#10, 7.16)	Hilly, leafy, split-level homes; 34 min; India-born 2.8% (245).
Ferntree Gully (#11, 7.06)	Flatter and busier than Upper Ferntree Gully (Nature 6, Shops 8); India-born 2.3% (632 people) (ABS). View as a pair with Upper Ferntree Gully.
Chelsea (#14, 6.82)	Flat, few trees; the 19-minute ED time looks high; India-born 1.4%.
Newtown, Geelong (#17, 6.62)	River sanctuary, Indian 5.4, ED about 7 min; 72 min to family; Jellis Craig median $1.08M.
Tecoma (#22, 6.15)	Sherbrooke Forest adjoins; tiny highway strip; on the 2017 overlay list; a swap-in for Upwey.
Montrose (#28, 5.44)	Foothills township, no station (Mooroolbark 5.7 km); on the 2017 overlay list.
Drouin (#30, 5.26)	Small town; ED is at Warragul; India-born 0.5% (postcode).
Gisborne (#31, 5.19)	Macedon Ranges town with modern estates (Shops 7, Nature 7); rail access unclear.
Olinda (#34, 4.78)	Ridge village, no supermarket in the centre; fire and insurance; India-born 0.4%.
Mount Dandenong (#35, 4.45)	Steep, narrow roads, few everyday services; only the SA2 census page was read.
Riddells Creek (#36, 4.38)	Small village, 71 min; median $1.01M on 30 sales, down 6.11% in the quarter.
Macedon (#37, 4.00)	Forest and Avenue of Honour; Shops 3; the 1983 Ash Wednesday fire destroyed 64 houses (Wikipedia); "limited afternoon services" by train (Wikipedia).

Suburb (rank, score)	Note
Rosebud (not ranked, 5.83)	Open-mind pick; Beach 10, Nature 6; flat; ED is lower-acuity, Frankston 27 min per the workbook.
Rye (not ranked, 5.37)	Open-mind pick; 61 min; route 786 was removed on 5 Jul 2026; seasonal.
McCrae (not ranked, 5.26)	Small strip, hilly behind; median age 55; ED is Rosebud (minor cases); price median not found.
Wonthaggi (not ranked, 5.22)	Bass Coast Health ED verified 24-hour (healthdirect); 88 min; median age 55; no rail.
Emerald (not ranked, 4.85)	Larger village with better odds of single-storey homes; 35 min; fire.
Kyneton (not ranked, 4.05)	Best heritage main street (Village 9); Bendigo Health ED is 54.6 km away (healthdirect); Jellis Craig median $840,000.
Healesville (not ranked, 3.87)	A real town centre (Shops 6) but the hospital has no urgent care; residents report going to Maroondah, about 50 min, with 4 to 5 hour waits (Upper Yarra Mail).
Arthurs Seat (not ranked, 4.64)	State Park forest (Nature 9) but no village, steep, and CFA fuel-reduction work at Pindara Rd in May 2026 (Mornington News); price rests on 5 sales.
Warburton (not ranked, 3.05)	Top-tier nature (10) but 65 min to family, 53 min to ED, one main road; median age 50.
Yarra Glen (not ranked, 3.78)	Vineyard flats, less forest (Nature 7); flood and fire both in play.

Where the workbook and the research disagree

Items 1 to 6 can move a ranking or a hard filter; 7 to 10 are 27 Oct issues now resolved in the workbook; 11 to 18 are smaller. "Effect" says what this report did.

#	Item	Workbook says	Research says	Effect and fix
1	**Highton price**	AVM $957,797	PRD Q2 2026 house median $781,500 (241 sales) (PRD)	Kept workbook figure (score effect not re-run on the workbook weights). Replace with a sale median.
2	**Healesville ED time**	33 min	Local paper: no urgent care; residents go to Maroondah, about 50 min (Upper Yarra Mail). Same worry for Yarra Glen (30) and Warburton (53)	Kept 33, flagged "?" (score effect not re-run). Re-time the true ED route.
3	**Peninsula ED times**	3 to 19 min for Dromana, Rye, McCrae, Rosebud, Mount Martha, Arthurs Seat	These measure the nearest ED (Rosebud, minor and moderate cases), not a major ED. Frankston is the major ED; the workbook gives Rosebud to Frankston as 27 min, other suburbs 30 to 45+ min (estimate) (Peninsula Health)	Marked "!". Rosebud (11th), Rye (13th) and Dromana (14th) rank just below the top 10 on these nearest-ED times; the effect of major-ED times has not been re-run. Add a "major ED" column.
4	**Ferntree Gully and Upper FTG price**	Both $872,133	OnTheHouse returns one postcode-level AVM; unit values differ ($678,759 vs unknown)	Marked ‡. Search each suburb's sold listings separately.
5	**Williamstown 3-bed evidence**	AVM $1,642,163, "needs data"	House median $1.58M (212 sales) (Property.com.au) or $1.49M (195 sales, down 5.4%) (Microburbs); 3-bed median $1.45M; 4-bed $1.92M. Sale dates not shown	Left out of ranking. About half of 3-bed sales are under the cap, but they cluster at the cheaper end; 3 adults each wanting a bedroom leaves no spare room. Check recent sold listings.
6	**Mum's 25-min Glen Waverley and 20-min ED answers vs the 90-min hard filter**	Hard filters 90 and 90 (Filters tab); Mum, Y: 25 and 20; Dad: 75 and no limit	**15 of 51** meet 25 and 20 (leave-now basis): Upper Ferntree Gully, Ferntree Gully, Upwey, Tecoma, Belgrave, The Basin, Montrose, Ringwood, Croydon, Heidelberg, Warrandyte, Mentone, Seaford, Frankston, Berwick. None on the Peninsula, in Macedon, Geelong or Gippsland	Family filter wins, as the workbook says. But ask Mum whether her numbers are limits or preferences (Round 2 follow-up). Of the anchors, Frankston (25) and Seaford (24) are inside them; Mordialloc (28) is not. Comparators are on the 10:00 weekday basis and are not compared.
7	**Essentials cap of 2**	Cap is 2 per person (Settings)	Round 2 ratings in the workbook: Mum has two Essentials (Hospital, Shops and doctor), Dad one (Nature), Y two (Nature, Beach)	Resolved: all within the cap. The 27 Oct issue (Mum with three) is superseded.
8	**Nature weight after the trade-offs**	Survey Nature 18.5%; final 14.4% after Q11 (Beach over Nature, 2–1) moved 4.1 points to Beach	The 27 Oct issue (Nature cut to 9% by a typed shift) is superseded: the workbook now applies the blueprint rule live	No change. Nature is the second-largest weight; Beach is the largest.

#	Item	Workbook says	Research says	Effect and fix
9	**Trade-off votes**	Q10 to Q13 recorded with each person's vote, all 2–1: Nature over Near family, Beach over Nature, Village over Shops, Nature over Indian community	The 27 Oct issue (placeholder cells, Q13 blank) is superseded	No change.
10	**Formulas need recalculation**	Weights, the formula scores (M, O, T) and the weighted score are formulas; the judgement scores are entered values	A file saved without recalculation can show blank cached values. This report read a recalculated copy of commit 7de29d5	Open and recalculate in Excel before relying on any total.
11	**Overseas-born figures**	Upper Ferntree Gully 19.2%; Frankston 22.5%	100 minus Australia-born gives about 22.8% and 29%; ABS pages do not print the figure. A secondary site's Mentone figure (84.7% Australia-born) conflicts with the workbook (28.8% overseas-born); the workbook looks right	Not used in scores. Likely a "not stated" definition gap.
12	**Price vs independent medians**	AVMs and 3-bed medians	Woodend all-house $1.04M vs 3-bed $890k; Macedon $1.04M vs AVM $1,147,643; Newtown $1.08M vs $1,182,945; Mornington $1.20M vs $1,096,505; Altona $1.25M vs $1,155,073; Torquay about $1.05M (low-quality source) vs $1.18M; Wonthaggi $542,500 vs $587,666; Mentone Woodards $1.30m vs $1,497,099	Marked †. Most gaps are under 20%; none changes cap status.
13	**Thin or odd price data**	Warburton 3-bed $717.5k, 4-bed $702.5k; Olinda and Sassafras unit AVMs above house AVMs; five suburbs under 40 sales	Thin sales (Macedon, Tecoma, Olinda, Sassafras, Mount Dandenong); units are 0 to 0.6% of stock in Olinda and Sassafras	Treat those prices as weak.
14	**Train Yes/No**	Gisborne "Yes" (station in New Gisborne, about 3 km); Croydon "Yes"	Researchers found no Gisborne station on the Bendigo line (estimate); Wikipedia showed Croydon station closed from March 2024 for level-crossing works; Macedon and Riddells Creek have "limited afternoon services"	Kept workbook Y; all are recall-based. Check PTV and V/Line.
15	**Other ED times**	Frankston South 4; Chelsea 19; Kyneton 47; Woodend 55; Torquay 23	Frankston South guess 8 to 12; Chelsea looks high; Kyneton to Bendigo is 54.6 km, marginal; Woodend plausible to Sunshine, optimistic to Bendigo; Torquay optimistic but plausible off-peak	Kept workbook values. Re-time.
16	**Heidelberg "borderline" on cost**	$1,452,000 under the $1.5M cap	One researcher called $1.54M with costs borderline. The cap applies to purchase price; the $1.59M ceiling includes the 6% allowance	No issue: $1.452M plus 6% is $1.539M. Thin sample (35 sales) is the real caution.
17	**Drive-time basis**	Leave now, 26 Oct (Active Shortlist ranked); Leave now, 27 Oct (Watchlist, Open-mind viewing, Frankston South); 10:00 weekday, 28 Oct (comparators, workbook J/K)	Woodend read 77 min on 27 Oct vs 68 on the sheet, so recent readings run about 10% high; Torquay and Wonthaggi (88) sit within 2 min of the hard limit; Newtown's origin is approximate; Gisborne timed from the post office	Labelled per row in this report. Re-run the anchors at 10:00 on a weekday so they compare like for like with the comparators.
18	**Single-level need vs stairs allowed**	Stairs allowed (corrected 27 Oct); Mum's survey answer: "None at all"	Cards flag sloping and split-level stock in Eltham, Rosanna, Warrandyte, the Dandenong ridge and the Peninsula	Test Mum's view at the first viewings.

What is still unverified, and what to check next

Unverified, in order of risk

Gap	What is known	How to close it
Hazard overlays (bushfire, flood, coastal)	Not read at property level for any suburb. Only council-wide lists (the 2017 Yarra Ranges overlay list for Belgrave, Montrose, Mount Evelyn, Tecoma, Upper Ferntree Gully and Upwey), local history and news	Check each address on VicPlan (VicPlan), ask for a planning certificate, get an insurance quote before offering.

Gap	What is known	How to close it
Indian groceries, temples, gurdwaras	**Checked for the six Community comparators** (named places and drive times in the comparator section; Endeavour Spices and Shri Sanatan Dharam's opening hours: NEEDS VERIFICATION). For the 51 ranked suburbs, named in the notes: Sri Vakrathunda Vinayagar temple (The Basin); Shiva Vishnu Temple (Carrum Downs) and Keysborough Gurdwara (Faith Victoria); a temple association in Geelong (address not found). Named grocers: **not found** for any of the 51 ranked suburbs. India-born share exact only where India is in the census top five	Build a short list of named shops and temples; time the drive from each shortlisted suburb.
Drive times at one consistent time	Ranked suburbs: Leave now, 26 Oct or Leave now, 27 Oct. Comparators: 10:00 weekday, 28 Oct (workbook J/K). The bases differ	Re-time the three anchors at Wed 10:00, to Glen Waverley and to the ED, so the options compare like for like.
Sale medians vs AVMs	38 of 51 ranked prices are AVMs, including Seaford and Mordialloc	Pull sold listings for 3+ bedroom houses in each shortlisted suburb.
Train Yes/No and frequency	From recall; V/Line frequency only system-wide	Check PTV and V/Line timetables; ask about Croydon and Gisborne stations.
ED status and waits	Read and confirmed 24-hour: Wonthaggi, Rosebud, Frankston, Footscray. Angliss and West Gippsland are marked verified in the workbook (Eastern Health site, shire directory) but the Angliss notes are mixed. Casey, Northern, Sunshine, Maroondah, Bendigo and Ballarat are from recall	Confirm and check typical waits.
Everyday services	Supermarket, GP and pharmacy names mostly unverified; bus frequencies not read	Measure the real drive to the nearest supermarket and GP.
Scores themselves	One researcher's judgement per suburb; Nature and Village are least verified	Each family member scores the option suburbs after viewing.

At inspection

Check	Why	Most relevant to
Overlay map and fire-season exit road, driven once	Single access roads and steep, narrow ridge roads	Warrandyte, Warburton, Sassafras, Olinda, Arthurs Seat, Hurstbridge
Stairs, slope and driveway, with Mum present	Her single-level answer is unresolved	Eltham, Rosanna, Warrandyte, ridge suburbs, Frankston South, Mount Martha
A winter-style drive (ice, fog, fallen trees)	Ridge and Macedon winters	Macedon Ranges, Dandenong ridge
Three bedrooms or a self-contained space	Three adults; Mum and Y chose "living together", Y a granny flat or separate unit	All; Williamstown-type 3-bed stock is tight
Garden upkeep	Dad's Q2 answer is "looking after the house and land"	Large bush blocks
Real walk to shops, GP and station	Parents expect to drive 10+ years, but not forever	Dandenong ridge villages, Macedon
Noise, flood and industry on the street	Flat coast and west suburbs	Altona, Newport, West Footscray, Chelsea, Mordialloc, Seaford
ED route and a test run	Peninsula and Macedon distances	Dromana, Rye, Woodend, Kyneton
Walk or drive to the grocer, temple and church	Tests whether the community side feels close in practice	Springvale, Clayton South, Keysborough, Endeavour Hills, Wheelers Hill

Open questions for the family

Question	Why it matters
Are Mum's 25-minute Glen Waverley and 20-minute ED answers limits or preferences?	On the "leave now" basis, 15 of the 51 meet both. Of the anchors, Frankston (25) and Seaford (24) do; Mordialloc (28) does not. Comparators are on the 10:00 weekday basis and are not compared.
Should the 60-minute preference become a working limit?	11 ranked suburbs are over 60 min (Warburton, Rye, Kyneton, Woodend, Macedon, Gisborne, Riddells Creek, Newtown, Highton, Torquay, Wonthaggi); Clyde North is 50 min at 10:00 weekday (peak (08:00) top 70, context only). None is in an option.

Question	Why it matters
What should the Indian-community score (P) measure?	P is unchanged and pending a family decision; the comparators' drive minutes to a grocery, temple and church are the evidence to judge it.
Q13d (reference-only)	Round 4 asks a 5-point green-village versus multicultural-neighbourhood question. It feeds no weight and is not in the workbook.
Point Cook	Conditional: it needs a family decision to accept a longer travel trade-off.

Conclusion

The research does not name a winner. Under the family's current weights the workbook ranks three bay suburbs first (Frankston, Mordialloc, Seaford), all Low on community and moderate on Nature. The Community comparators show the other side: Springvale, Clayton South and Keysborough are High on community with little nature, and Endeavour Hills is the one suburb found so far that offers both, with a bush reserve, a confirmed temple, a grocer and a church within about 15 minutes. Wheelers Hill is the closest to family but sits 1.7% under the cap. Its budget evidence is CHECKED, but no suitable house has been verified.

Option A shows the starkest contrast; Options B and C each include both Potential-both suburbs. If the family comes back from Springvale or Clayton South preferring them, the Indian-community weight (7.9%) is understated. If they come back preferring the bay anchors, the current weights stand. Before any offer, every suburb still needs property-level checks: sold prices for suitable houses, overlay maps and an insurance quote.

Sources

Sources are the researchers' notes (Dandenong foothills, ridge and Yarra Valley, north-east, Mornington Peninsula, bayside and south-east, Macedon and Geelong, west and Gippsland), the workbook at commit 5704d65 and the Community comparators research file. Main sources are linked in the cards. Others used:

Topic	Source
Census 2021 QuickStats	ABS, one page per suburb; links in the cards and below
ABS Ringwood	https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL22174
ABS Heidelberg, Rosanna	https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL21167, https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL22194
ABS Chelsea, Mordialloc, Frankston	https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL20537, https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL21760, https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL20947
Local ED and hospital	Peninsula Health, healthdirect, Vic Health (linked above)
Prices	Jellis Craig suburb reports, PRD, Microburbs, Property.com.au, Domain, Collings (linked above)
Bush and flood history	Wikipedia pages for each suburb; Star Mail; Manningham Council; VICSES; Mornington News
Drive times and the family's rules	Workbook, Filters and SuburbScorecard tabs (Google Maps "leave now" readings, 26 and 27 Oct 2026)
Community comparators	`Community comparators — research (28 Oct 2026).md`: Google Maps directions and place listings (28 Oct 2026), Victorian Statements of Information, Jellis Craig Wheelers Hill report (Sep 2026), healthdirect, Victorian Department of Health, Mercy Health, ABS 2021 General Community Profile; workbook SuburbScorecard rows 67–72 and DiscussionSummary A31:B38